

The key ring

User, role, policy, SCP, and STS.

Copy the Voice-over block. Timed lines are for editing. No storyteller kid in the picture — voice only.

VOICE-OVER (COPY THIS)

Welcome back to Cloud Town, high up in the sky! This is Episode 7. Today we open the key ring all the way. That is IAM. A user is a kid with a name tag. That kid lives in town. A role is a badge you borrow for one job, then you give it back. A policy is the list of may and may-not on the door. An SCP is the principal's rule. No classroom may break it, even if a teacher says yes. STS is a visitor pass that peels off at sunset. You borrow keys for a little while, then they vanish. Name tag. Borrowed badge. Door list. Principal's rule. Sunset pass. Now you know IAM!

TIMED LINES

0:00.10 – 0:04.38	Welcome back to Cloud Town, high up in the sky!
0:04.38 – 0:06.91	This is Episode 7.
0:06.91 – 0:10.51	Today we open the key ring all the way.
0:10.51 – 0:12.59	That is IAM.
0:12.59 – 0:16.00	A user is a kid with a name tag.
0:16.00 – 0:18.61	That kid lives in town.
0:18.61 – 0:23.97	A role is a badge you borrow for one job, then you give it back.
0:23.97 – 0:28.39	A policy is the list of may and may-not on the door.
0:28.39 – 0:31.84	An SCP is the principal's rule.
0:31.84 – 0:36.85	No classroom may break it, even if a teacher says yes.
0:36.85 – 0:41.66	STS is a visitor pass that peels off at sunset.
0:41.66 – 0:46.17	You borrow keys for a little while, then they vanish.
0:46.17 – 0:48.00	Name tag.
0:48.00 – 0:49.96	Borrowed badge.
0:49.96 – 0:51.78	Door list.
0:51.78 – 0:53.84	Principal's rule.
0:53.84 – 0:56.00	Sunset pass.
0:56.00 – 1:00.00	Now you know IAM!

CHAPTERS

0:00.00 – 0:23.97	User · role
0:23.97 – 0:36.85	Policy · SCP
0:36.85 – 1:00.00	STS

NEIGHBORS (KID WORD = AWS)

Name tag = IAM user

A kid who lives in town

A user is a kid with a name tag. That kid lives here.

An IAM user is a long-lived identity in your account — a person or a program with its own name tag. Prefer roles for jobs that can borrow keys instead.

Borrowed badge = IAM role

One job, then give it back

A role is a badge you borrow for one job, then you give it back.

An IAM role is a set of permissions you assume. EC2, Lambda, and people in other accounts can borrow it. Nobody keeps the badge in their pocket forever.

Door list = IAM policy

May and may-not

A policy is the list of may and may-not on the door.

An IAM policy is JSON that Allow or Deny actions on resources. Identity policies hang on users, groups, and roles. Resource policies hang on Sammy's bucket or a KMS lock.

Principal's rule = SCP

No classroom may break it

An SCP is the principal's rule. Even if a teacher says yes, the classroom still may not.

A Service Control Policy is a guardrail from AWS Organizations. It limits every account in the family. An Allow in IAM cannot beat an SCP Deny — the principal's book sits above the classroom.

Sunset pass = AWS STS

Keys that vanish

STS is a visitor pass that peels off at sunset. You borrow keys, then they vanish.

AWS Security Token Service hands out temporary credentials when you assume a role. Access key, secret, and session token expire. That is safer than a permanent name-tag password.

QUIZ

1. Who is a kid with a name tag who lives in town?

Choices: Name tag · Borrowed badge · Sunset pass

Answer: Name tag (IAM user)

2. What is a badge you borrow for one job, then give back?

Choices: Name tag · Borrowed badge · Door list

Answer: Borrowed badge (IAM role)

3. Which rule no classroom may break, even if a teacher says yes?

Choices: Door list · Principal's rule · Sunset pass

Answer: Principal's rule (SCP)

4. What peels off at sunset?

Choices: Sunset pass · Borrowed badge · Principal's rule

Answer: Sunset pass (AWS STS)

RECAP

Name tag. Borrowed badge. Door list. Principal's rule. Sunset pass. That is IAM, working together.

Yes! A user has a name tag. A role is borrowed. A policy is may and may-not. An SCP is the principal's rule. STS is a sunset pass.